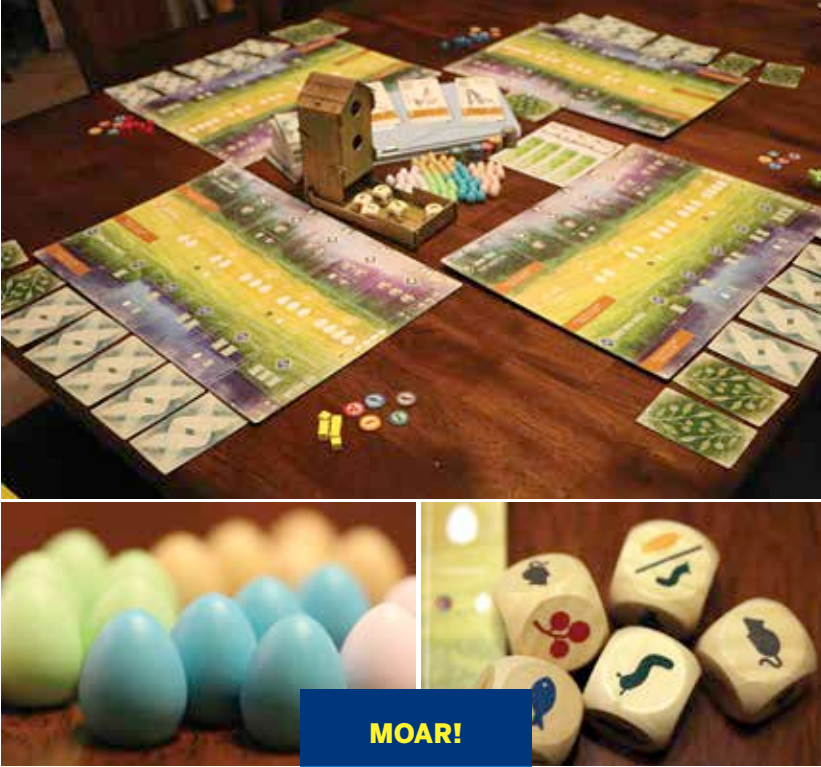




MOAR!

PLAYERS:

2-5 players

AGE GROUP:

10+

PUBLISHER:

Stonemaier Games

PLAYING TIME:

30-90 mins

BOARD GAME

PRICE:

5,599

STEAM PRICE:

529

keep track of what other players are doing and anticipate their next moves. The wide variety of the powers in play means that players can capitalise on an opportunity and entirely change the course of their game. In fact, it is all about letting the ecosystem evolve, adapting and taking advantage of whatever conditions present themselves, and making each action increasingly powerful by triggering chain reactions in the powers of the birds.

VERDICT

The board game is one of the best

there is, and we would really like to see more engine building titles with deep strategy in the market. Like most of the modern games, it does have a lot of components to keep track of, and stacking unlimited food tokens as well as tucking of cards can make the board a bit messy towards the end of the game. This is not a party game, but accommo-

dates up to five players which is at the right sweet spot. Unlike many other titles, the game is as fun with two to five people, with the experience or type of game not changing much. That is you do not need a dif-

ferent strategy for three player games and five player games, like you do in 7 Wonders or Puerto Rico. This is a highly recommended title for your shelf, if nothing else then just for the beautiful deck of hand drawn birds. There seems to be a series of expansions planned, perhaps focusing on the birds from each continent. The European and Oceania expansions are already out. Ignoring all thematic aspects about environmentalism and how cool the birds are, this is just a really fun and nail biting game to play, and you end up getting the birds to work for you, so you end up feeling like the bourgeoisie.

The Steam version is just a spectacular engine building strategy game on its own, perfectly playable even if you are not that much interested in board games. It is a relaxing experience, with calming gentle music, and you are practically ushered through all the steps through clear on-screen instructions. It is like an interactive slideshow where you participate by choosing the birds that you want to build into your ecosystem, making it increasingly powerful. The bird calls and the fun facts really add to the experience, and so do the charming animations on the birds. This is one of those cases where 2D animations with stretching, pulling and deforming is really well done, because the form factor of birds lends itself to that kind of animation. There is an AI that lets you play with as many AI players as you need, with plenty of options for fine tuning how difficult they each are. There is also Automa, a virtual electromechanical bird powered by meatspace silicon, that is just a tiny little spitfire, matching you move for move and keeping you on your toes throughout the game, no matter what your skill level is. The game is popular enough to have steady matchmaking, and there is a helpful and kind community over at Discord as well, with a focus on getting people together for games. The Steam version is also highly recommended, and we'd say just get both. *

